that soars close to the sun, all indicating the greatness of the occupant'. Understatement, for Salim, was not an option. If the image was eloquent enough then the verses surrounding the painting made their intent even more undeniable:

> In the time of the lion-capturing prince… In a year when the treasure-bestowing prince rode his steed out to chastise the Rana (the artist) Manohar, who with a stroke of his princely-approved pen would cause sperm to take shape in the womb, drew a likeness of a king as glorious as Jamshid. Mansur's brush worked on it (also). Now…without error seek the year from (the words) 'likeness of the emperor'.

The chronogram[*] from the painting dates it to 1601, a time when this 'Emperor' was definitely de trop, for the kingdom already had a Padshah, and Salim's claim was therefore treasonous.

Salim's pointed patronage of the Persianate style at the time of his rebellion can be seen in a work of prodigious scope and imagination—the *Muraqqa-e Gulshan*, or the Gulshan Album.[†] Kavita Singh has described the album as 'primarily an archival project that was designed to bring together rare and precious works on paper, including calligraphy, paintings, drawings and engravings'. These works had probably been accumulated in the imperial library through generations of Timurid rulers, as individual folios and documents. Salim began collecting these documents from the time he was at Akbar's court, many of them dating from the time of Humayun and before, thus allowing the prince to reach back in time and claim a legacy that bypassed his father's. At the atelier in Allahabad these folios were not just randomly put together but carefully and imaginatively assembled to demonstrate historicity, story-telling, inventiveness, and craft, much in the manner of a modern-day museum curator. Since these pages of calligraphy and paintings were of different sizes, the folios in the album had to be large, and so the empty spaces in the margins around the works were filled with images drawn by the painters of Salim's nascent studio. The paintings in the margins of this album are marvellous worlds within worlds. In them, birds tumble through the sepia pages, flowers bloom, men and women toil and labour at various tasks, muscles straining, faces grimacing, giving us a unique insight into everyday life in the seventeenth century. There are noblemen and courtiers, fantastical animals and domesticated